

Crisis (IPC phase 3) in the eastern parts of the country are likely to persist

Key Messages

- Cumulative June to September 2019 *Kiremt* rainfall is above average across most of the country. In some areas along riverbanks and lake shores, heavy rainfall led to flooding and water logging of crops, resulting in localized crop losses. Conversely, in areas of northern Afar, northeastern Amhara, and eastern Tigray, *Kiremt* rainfall was poorly distributed and below average, negatively impacting cropping conditions. However, relatively heavy late season rainfall in these areas is improving pasture conditions.
- Generally, planting of 2019 *Meher* crops was timely, and the area planted of short and long maturing crops is near normal in major *Meher* producing parts of the country. Crops are in different growth stages, and the harvest of barley and potatoes has started in northeastern Amhara and Tigray in September. In other parts of the country, crop stages range from fruiting and grain filling to maturity. Despite localized crop losses due to poor rainfall, national *Meher* production is expected to be near average.
- Households in most *Meher*-producing areas have exhausted their food stocks from the previous season and are relying on markets. Atypically high market demand due to below average 2018 *Meher* and *Belg* production, restricted supply, and macroeconomic factors are driving significantly above average staple food prices. According to the Department of Risk Management (DRM), August sorghum prices in Woldia in Amhara are 127 and 98 percent above last year's prices and the five-year average, respectively. According to the Tseasie Tseada Emba DRM office in Afar, August maize prices are 40 percent above the same month last year and the five-year average. Livestock prices and labor wage rates are increasing, but at a slower rate than staple food prices, restricting household food access.
- Many pastoral and agropastoral areas of Somali Region, Eastern Oromia, Lowlands of Bale, Guji, Borana zones of Oromia, northern Afar and Waghimra areas along Tekeze Catchment are in Crisis (IPC Phase 3) and Stressed (IPC Phase 2). This is due to the below average 2019 *Belg* harvest, poor *Dyer/Hagaya* rains in pastoral areas that have resulted in below-average food and income from livestock, and well above-average staple food prices that have driven a deterioration in household purchasing power.

* FEWS NET's classifications are IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners. As of IPC 3.0, the IPC no longer assesses the impact of food assistance on classification and thus no longer maps the (!). However, FEWS NET continues to produce food security maps inclusive of the (!) as well as maps compatible with IPC 3.0/3.1, which include the mapping of food security assistance bags. FEWS NET and the IPC use different methods to estimate the total Population in Need of humanitarian food assistance and assess the risk of Famine. Learn more at www.fews.net/about.

Key Message Update

This Key Message Update provides a high-level analysis of current acute food insecurity conditions and any changes to FEWS NET's latest projection of acute food insecurity outcomes in the specified geography. Learn more [here](#).